

1917, January 1

FATHER SOLANUS, NOTEBOOK No. 2

Pg. 37

For Jan. 1st 10 A.M. 1917

"And His Name was called Jesus." Luke II, 22

When the Son of God became man, born on Christmas morning there was joy in Heaven and ~~as well~~ as on earth. There was joy among the angels; joy in the hearts of the simple shepherds; joy in the East where for centuries the Maji had waited and watched for the "star" that was to rise out of Jacob, now unmistakably risen in the West. In short there was joy wherever good will prevailed, wherever faith, wherever charity reigned. But above all joy, as the very source of happiness, there was peace at the Crib in the Stable at Bethlehem, peace and joy that surpasseth all understanding - peace and joy in the hearts of Jesus Mary and Joseph. The divine Prince of Peace had come the Eternal "Angel" of the great council and glory to God was proclaimed in the highest and on earth, "Peace to men of good will." But -- we ought to rejoice also not only on Christmas morning but today as well when the Gloria resounds 1st in the New Yr. The Son of God, that Prince of Peace, etc. etc. -- was born for us too if we will. He came not for one generation only or for one nation only but for all generations till the end of time, for every one who would believe in His name. He was to be a Saviour indeed. Therefore, the eternal decree "Thou shalt call His name Jesus, for He shall save his people from their sins." Jesus therefore must mean Saviour "and of His kingdom there shall be no end." The gospel for this feast gives us the record of that event, that naming of the Saviour, "and-- his name -- Jesus." Today He not only receives His name but in receiving it He undergoes the painful baptism of the Old Law. He is circumcised, He suffers for His people shedding His blood the first time for them, He shows Himself a Saviour. In fact, He takes here, as it were His first step in establishing His kingdom on earth. "And - His name was called Jesus." The question now is, "Who is going to belong to this kingdom of the Saviour's? Who is going to profit by His coming, by His sufferings and sacrifices? The Jews naturally thought it to be self understood that the Messiah would come to free them at least if not themselves exclusively. The nations and tribes outside the chosen people, hardly hoped He would be for them, if indeed they believed in Him at all. Whom, then, did He come to save? St. John answers this question in the first chapter of his Holy Gospel. In the beginning --- "All- were made by Him -- that believe in His Name. Do we believe in His name?--? or are we only Christians in name?